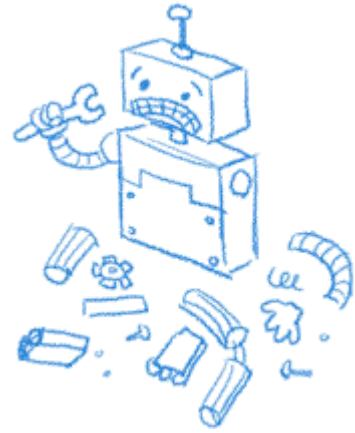




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THE CHURCH OF

*Our Lady of Lourdes**Serving the Parishes of Steelstown & Culmore***Sunday 4th October 2026****28th Sunday in Ordinary Time (A)****MASS TIMES****SUNDAYS**

Vigil: 6.30pm
Sunday: 09.00am;
 11.00am;
 12.15pm

WEEKDAYS

Monday – Friday: 7.45am
Monday: 7.00pm
Tuesday – Saturday: 10.00am

CONFESSIONS**WEEKEND**

Saturday: After 10am Mass;
 5.45pm – 6.25pm
Sunday: 10.30am – 10.50am

WEEKDAYS

Monday: 6.30pm – 6.55pm
Tuesday: 8.10am – 8.30am
Thursday: 9.30am – 09.50am

DEVOTIONS**EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION**

Thursday: 08.00 – 09.55am
 10.30am – 12 noon

ROSARY

Before 10am Mass

DIVINE MERCY CHAPLET

After 10am Mass

‘A Million Children Praying the Rosary’

On Thursday evening, Pope Leo XIV joined hundreds of schoolchildren at the Lourdes Grotto in the Vatican Gardens to pray the Rosary and launch this year’s ‘A Million Children Praying the Rosary’ campaign. The initiative started in 2005, in Caracas, Venezuela. While a group of children were praying the Rosary at a roadside shrine, several women who saw them recalled the words of Padre Pio: “When a million children start praying the rosary, the world will change!” The women sparked a movement to get one million children to pray the rosary in October. With the help of the Pontifical Foundation, ‘Aid to the Church in Need’, this has become an annual worldwide event, and Pope Leo is asking parishes, schools, parents and grandparents to encourage children to pray the rosary this month.

Last year, at the invitation of Aid to the Church in Need (Ireland), children from Steelstown Primary School joined with schoolchildren from Holy Family School in Gaza in a day-long recitation of the Rosary. Classes took it in turn to pray a decade, and they received a set of rosary beads made by Christians in Bethlehem. All our schools will be taking part in the initiative again this year, and we encourage everyone to unite with them on Wednesday 7th October, offering the Rosary for peace in our country and in our world.

The rosary is recited here on Mondays at 6.30pm, and on Tuesdays-Saturdays at 9.30am. Please consider joining us in this month of October.

**PARISH OFFICE**

Wednesday – Friday: 9am – 3pm

028 7135 1718

steelstown@derrydiocese.org / culmoreparish@derrydiocese.org

PRIEST

Rev. Declan McGeehan P.P./Adm.
declan.mcgeehan@derrydiocese.org

Urgent sick calls: 073 5238 7817

BAPTISMS – We welcome into the family of the Church: Elsié Mae Fox; Callé Harkin; Theo McBride and Odhran O'Donnell.

SYMPATHY –We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of: Bernard Sheils, 40 Upper Galliagh Road.

ANNIVERSARIES –Please pray for the repose of the souls of: Helen Bell; James McLaughlin; Frederick Bridge; Edward McDonagh; Gerard Hasson; Margaret Hasson; Bridie Burns; Elizabeth O'Loughlin; Denis McCourt; Johnny O'Donnell; Catherine Stephenson; Charlie Mullan; Jean Curran; Kathleen McTaggart and Roddy McTaggart.

SVDP – Acknowledge with thanks a donation of £150 from the Thursday craft group.

VOCATIONS TO THE PRIESTHOOD – Are you 18 years or older and thinking about serving the Church as a priest of the Diocese of Derry? There will be an afternoon talk with time for prayer, discussion, questions & answers in Derry City on Sunday 11 October. For further details, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan at: pgoh2111@gmail.com.

MINISTRY TO THE SICK – Would you be willing to bring Holy Communion to the sick in their own homes or in care centres in our parishes? If so, please contact the Parish Office for further information.

THORNHILL MINISTRIES – will lead an introduction to the practice of praying Scripture in a reflective way that will help participants let the Word of God to nestle in the quiet corner of the heart. *'Open heart - Open to the Word'* series of 4 Sundays in October 3:30 - 4:30 pm Emmaus Room, Pennyburn Church. All welcome.

FOYLE HOSPICE – will be hosting its Annual Coffee Morning on Saturday 10 October, from 10am to 1pm, at Day Therapy, Foyle Hospice, 61 Culmore Road, Derry~Londonderry. All welcome!

THE PADRE PIO PRAYER GROUP – Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, will take place on Tuesday 6 October 2026. Starting with Rosary at 6.45pm before Mass, celebration of Mass at 7.15pm, then the priest will bless everyone with a first-class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited. All welcome.

LUMEN CHRISTI COLLEGE 30TH ANNIVERSARY – Gala event in the Everglades Hotel, Friday 23 October: Night at the Races, meal and dancing! Tickets available from the college reception. All welcome!

GIVE A STUDENTS A TRUE DERRY WELCOME –For many of our students, coming to Derry is their first time away from home. At Foyle International, we are looking for local people who can offer more than just a spare room. A shared meal, a chat at the end of the day, a bit of advice, a laugh around the kitchen table these small everyday moments can make a huge difference to a student settling into life in Derry. If you have a spare room and would love to give an international student a true Derry welcome, we'd love to hear from you. Call Foyle International on 02871371535 for more information.

OUR LADY, UNTIER OF KNOTS NOVENA – The Novena to Our Lady, Untier of Knots began on Thursday, 1 October in Saint Eugene's Cathedral. It will continue for the following eight Thursdays, concluding on 26 November. This Novena reminds us that sin never entangled Our Lady, and that Christ gave us His Mother as Our Lady, Untier of Knots. Through this devotion, we entrust our personal "knots" to her loving care—learning to let go and allowing her to gently untie what binds us. All are welcome.

ABIDE WOMEN'S CONFERENCE – November 20-22, the Great Northern Hotel Bundoran, Co. Donegal. Speakers include: Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee Wooling, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Dominicans & more, Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, from Cork & Ross Diocese. All welcome. For more details, please visit Abide in His Love at [eventbrite.com](https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com)Registration link: <https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com>.

POPE'S PRAYER INTENTION FOR OCTOBER – For mental health ministry Let us pray that mental health ministry be established throughout the Church, helping to overcome the stigma and discrimination of persons with mental illnesses.

SAFEGUARDING NOTICE – We are committed to ensuring the safety and well-being of everyone in our parishes. If you have any concerns regarding the safeguarding of children or adults in need of protection within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person, on 07596 500793; or email: marie.okane@derrydiocese.org